

CLAT Express - June 2026: Study Notes

Chapters, topics and sub-topics with key facts, memory aids and mind-map outlines.

International Relations and News

U.S.-Iran Preliminary Peace Accord 2026

Islamabad MoU and the 14-point roadmap

The United States and Iran signed the Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding in June 2026. The MoU is an interim diplomatic framework rather than a permanent peace treaty. It provides for an immediate ceasefire, a 60-day negotiation process, and phased steps on Strait of Hormuz traffic and sanctions.

- US and Iran signed the Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) in June 2026.
- The Islamabad MoU is an Interim Diplomatic Framework, not a Permanent Peace Treaty.
- Immediate ceasefire followed by a 60-day negotiation process.
- Negotiations cover nuclear issues, regional security and sanctions relief.
- The proposed arrangement includes a 14-point MoU roadmap.
- Strait of Hormuz to reopen and commercial maritime traffic restored during the 60-day window.
- Phased sanctions relief and easing of restrictions on Iranian oil exports.
- Iran to downblend highly enriched uranium under IAEA supervision.
- Iran to refrain from nuclear weapon development.
- Proposal for a UN Security Council-backed Comprehensive Agreement after negotiations conclude.

Mnemonic - 60-day negotiation agenda: NRS: Nuclear, Regional, Sanctions

N = Nuclear issues are on the negotiation agenda; R = Regional security is on the negotiation agenda; S = Sanctions relief is on the negotiation agenda

Mind-map outline

Islamabad MoU

- Interim diplomatic framework
- Ceasefire and Hormuz reopening
- 60-day negotiation process
 - Nuclear issues
 - Regional security
 - Sanctions relief
- Iran nuclear commitments
 - Downblend HEU under IAEA supervision
 - No nuclear weapon development

Iran-U.S. nuclear diplomacy: JCPOA to 2018

The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (2015) set limits on Iran's nuclear programme in return for easing of international sanctions. The United States withdrew from the nuclear agreement in 2018. Iran then gradually scaled back its compliance with several JCPOA commitments.

- JCPOA was concluded in 2015 between Iran and the P5+1 countries.
- Iran agreed to restrict uranium enrichment activities under the JCPOA.
- Iran agreed to reduce its nuclear stockpiles under the JCPOA.
- Iran agreed to permit enhanced international inspections under the JCPOA.
- In return, international economic and financial sanctions on Iran were eased.
- In 2018, the United States withdrew from the nuclear agreement.
- Iran gradually scaled back compliance with several JCPOA commitments.
- The scaled-back commitments related mainly to uranium enrichment and nuclear monitoring.

Mnemonic - JCPOA key provisions: RRP: Restrict, Reduce, Permit

R = Restrict uranium enrichment activities; R = Reduce nuclear stockpiles; P = Permit enhanced international inspections

Mind-map outline

Iran nuclear diplomacy

- JCPOA concluded in 2015

- Iran restricts uranium enrichment
- Iran reduces nuclear stockpiles
- Iran permits enhanced inspections
- Sanctions eased in return
- US withdrew in 2018
- Iran scaled back compliance
 - Uranium enrichment commitments
 - Nuclear monitoring commitments

Three strategic pillars and their impact

The booklet groups the accord's benefits into three pillars: regional stability, energy markets and economic development. Reopening the Strait of Hormuz is expected to cut freight and insurance costs. Persistent regional tensions and doubts about the 60-day timeline are the main challenges.

- Pillar 1: Strengthening regional stability, through reduced conflict risks and an improved security environment.
- Pillar 2: Energy market benefits, including reduced oil price volatility.
- Pillar 3: Economic developmental gains, including stimulated trade and investment.
- Reopening the Strait of Hormuz reduces freight and insurance costs.
- Lower crude oil prices would lower India's inflationary pressures and current account deficit.
- Reintegration of Iran boosts the Chabahar Port and the International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC).
- Experts doubt a comprehensive settlement can be concluded within the two-month timeframe.
- Tensions between Israel and Hezbollah, and Iranian regional proxies, continue to persist.

Mnemonic - Three strategic pillars: RED: Regional, Energy, Development

R = Pillar 1: strengthening regional stability; E = Pillar 2: energy market benefits; D = Pillar 3: economic developmental gains

Mind-map outline

Strategic dividends

- Pillar 1: regional stability
 - Reduced conflict risks
 - Improved security environment
- Pillar 2: energy market benefits
 - Reduced oil price volatility
 - Cheaper Hormuz freight and insurance
- Pillar 3: economic developmental gains
 - Stimulated trade and investment
 - Enhanced regional connectivity

IAEA: origins, objectives and leadership

The International Atomic Energy Agency was founded in 1957 and is an intergovernmental organization. It grew out of the 1953 Atoms for Peace speech by US President Dwight D.

Eisenhower. Its objectives are to promote peaceful use of nuclear energy and to inhibit its use for military purposes.

- IAEA was founded in 1957.
- IAEA was born out of US President Dwight D. Eisenhower's Atoms for Peace speech to the UNGA in 1953.
- IAEA is an intergovernmental organization.
- Objective: to promote peaceful use of nuclear energy.
- Objective: to inhibit use of nuclear energy for any military purpose.
- IAEA was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 2005.
- Head of the IAEA: Rafael Grossi.
- Headquarters of the IAEA: Vienna, Austria.

Mind-map outline

IAEA

- Founded 1957
- Born from 1953 Atoms for Peace speech

- Objective: peaceful nuclear energy
 - Inhibit military use
- Nobel Peace Prize 2005
- Head: Rafael Grossi
- Headquarters: Vienna, Austria

Myanmar President's India Visit

Visit Outcomes

Myanmar's President Min Aung Hlaing made a five-day official visit to India, his first since the political transition in Myanmar. The talks produced commitments on border security, a currency settlement framework, connectivity projects and scholarships. Both sides reaffirmed the Kaladan project and agreed to expedite the Trilateral Highway.

- Myanmar's President Min Aung Hlaing made a five-day official visit to India.
- It was his first visit to India since the political transition in Myanmar.
- Myanmar assured India that its territory would not be used by anti-India insurgent groups near the border.
- Both sides agreed to promote greater use of the Rupee-Kyat settlement framework, operational since 2024.
- Both countries reaffirmed their commitment to complete the Kaladan project at the earliest.
- Efforts were announced to expedite the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway.
- India increased the number of Mekong-Ganga ICCR scholarships for Myanmar students from 36 to 100.

Mind-map outline

Visit Outcomes

- Security
 - No territory for anti-India insurgents
- Economy
 - Rupee-Kyat settlement framework
- Connectivity
 - Kaladan project: early completion
 - Trilateral Highway: expedite
- People
 - ICCR scholarships: 36 to 100

Historical Background

Much of India's North-East was under Burmese occupation until the Treaty of Yandaboo, signed in 1826 to end the Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-1826. The treaty established the current India-Myanmar boundary. General Sir Archibald Campbell signed it on behalf of the British.

- Much of India's North-East Region was under Burmese occupation until the Treaty of Yandaboo.
- The Treaty of Yandaboo was signed in 1826.
- The treaty ended the Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-1826.
- General Sir Archibald Campbell signed the treaty on behalf of the British.
- The treaty established the current India-Myanmar boundary.

Mind-map outline

Historical Background

- Before 1826
 - Burmese occupation of much of North-East
- Treaty of Yandaboo, 1826
 - Ended Anglo-Burmese War (1824-1826)
 - Signed for British by Gen. Sir Archibald Campbell
 - Established current India-Myanmar boundary

Strategic Importance and Relations

Myanmar is India's only ASEAN neighbour connected through both land and maritime boundaries, which makes it a geographic bridge to Southeast Asia. Cooperation with Myanmar is important for tackling insurgency, narcotics trafficking and cross-border crime. Ties are framed within India's Act East and Neighbourhood First policies.

- Myanmar is India's only ASEAN neighbour connected through both land and maritime boundaries.
- India shares a border of 1643 km with Myanmar across Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram.
- India and Myanmar share a maritime boundary in the Bay of Bengal.
- Myanmar acts as a bridge between South Asia and South-East Asia.
- India and Myanmar signed a Treaty of Friendship in 1951.
- Cooperation with Myanmar is critical for tackling insurgency, narcotics trafficking, illegal arms smuggling and cross-border crime.
- Myanmar is a member of BIMSTEC, a SAARC observer and part of the Mekong-Ganga Cooperation.
- Bilateral trade is conducted under the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA).

Mnemonic - BAMS for regional ties: BAMS: Bold Asian Mates Shine

B = BIMSTEC: Myanmar is a member; A = AITIGA: governs bilateral trade between India and Myanmar;

M = Mekong-Ganga Cooperation: Myanmar is part of it; S = SAARC: Myanmar is an observer

Mind-map outline

Strategic Importance

- Geography
 - Only ASEAN neighbour with land and sea boundaries
 - 1643 km land border
 - Maritime boundary in Bay of Bengal
- Diplomacy
 - Treaty of Friendship, 1951
 - Act East and Neighbourhood First
- Regional bodies
 - BIMSTEC member
 - SAARC observer
 - Mekong-Ganga Cooperation
- Trade
 - AITIGA trade framework

Connectivity Projects

The Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project links Kolkata with Sittwe Seaport in Rakhine, Myanmar, via the Bay of Bengal. The India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway runs from Moreh in Manipur through Myanmar to Mae Sot in Thailand. Both projects featured in the outcomes of the visit.

- The Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project links Kolkata with Sittwe Seaport in Rakhine, Myanmar.
- The Kaladan project links India and Myanmar via the Bay of Bengal.
- The India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway is 1,360 km long.
- The Trilateral Highway starts from Moreh in Manipur.
- The Trilateral Highway passes through Myanmar before reaching Mae Sot in Thailand.
- Both countries reaffirmed commitment to complete Kaladan at the earliest, and efforts to expedite the Trilateral Highway were announced.

Mind-map outline

Connectivity Projects

- Kaladan Multi-Modal Project
 - Kolkata to Sittwe seaport
 - Links India and Myanmar via Bay of Bengal
- Trilateral Highway
 - Length 1,360 km
 - Moreh to Mae Sot via Myanmar

Myanmar's Political Background

The military seized power in Myanmar on February 1, 2021, after alleging huge irregularities in the November parliamentary polls. Aung San Suu Kyi and other civilian leaders were taken into custody, and a one-year state of emergency was declared. The NLD had won landslide victories in 2015 and 2020.

- The military seized power on February 1, 2021.
- The military alleged huge irregularities in the November parliamentary polls.
- The army declared a one-year state of emergency.
- Myint Swe, a former general and the vice president, was to become acting president.
- Aung San Suu Kyi and other civilian leaders were taken into custody hours before parliament was due to convene.
- Internet and mobile phone communications were severely restricted and all banks were closed nationwide.

Mind-map outline

Political Background

- Coup, Feb 1, 2021
 - Alleged irregularities in November polls
 - One-year state of emergency declared
- Detentions
 - Aung San Suu Kyi and civilian leaders detained
 - Myint Swe to become acting president
- Restrictions
 - Internet and phones severely restricted
 - All banks closed nationwide

National News and Issues

PM Modi Became India's Longest Continuously Serving Elected PM

Modi's Record-Breaking Continuous Tenure

Narendra Modi became India's longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister after completing 4,399 consecutive days in office since 26 May 2014. He surpassed the uninterrupted tenure record held by Jawaharlal Nehru. The milestone is the longest uninterrupted period served by a democratically elected Prime Minister in independent India.

- Modi completed 4,399 consecutive days in office.
- He has been in office since 26 May 2014.
- He surpassed the uninterrupted tenure record held by Jawaharlal Nehru.
- It is the longest uninterrupted period served by a democratically elected PM in independent India.
- Nehru's overall tenure as Prime Minister lasted approximately 6,131 days.
- Nehru's cumulative tenure includes his time as PM of the Interim Government.
- Gulzari Lal Nanda was interim PM on both occasions.

Mind-map outline

Record of continuous service

- Consecutive days: 4,399
- Start date: 26 May 2014
- Record surpassed: Nehru's tenure record
- Nehru's overall tenure: about 6,131 days

Constitutional Position of the Prime Minister

The Prime Minister is the head of the Union Government and the leader of the Council of Ministers. The booklet describes the PM as head of the executive, chairperson of the Union Cabinet and chief coordinator of government policy and administration. Article 74 provides for a Council of Ministers headed by the PM to aid and advise the President, while Article 75 deals with the appointment, tenure and responsibilities of the PM and the Council of Ministers.

- The PM is the Head of the Executive.
- The PM is the Chairperson of the Union Cabinet.

- The PM is Head of the Union Government and leader of the Council of Ministers.
- The PM is the chief coordinator of government policy and administration.
- If a member of Lok Sabha, the PM is its leader.
- Article 74 provides for a Council of Ministers headed by the PM to aid and advise the President.
- Article 75 deals with the appointment, tenure and responsibilities of the PM and Council of Ministers.
- Article 163 establishes State Councils of Ministers led by the Chief Minister to aid and advise the Governor.

Mind-map outline

Constitutional position of the PM

- Head of the Executive
- Chairperson of Union Cabinet
- Chief coordinator of policy
- Article 74: Council of Ministers
- Article 75: appointment and tenure

Appointment, Tenure and the Council of Ministers

The President appoints the PM but is not free in the selection, and normally invites the leader of the majority party in the Lok Sabha to form the government. If no single party has a clear majority, the President invites a person likely to command support of two or more parties that make up a Lok Sabha majority. The PM holds office during the pleasure of the President but cannot be dismissed while enjoying majority support in the Lok Sabha. Rules for the Council of Ministers include a 15% size cap and a six-month limit for ministers who are not in Parliament.

- The President normally invites the leader of the majority party to form the government.
- If no single party has a clear majority, the President invites a person who can command support of two or more parties forming a Lok Sabha majority.
- The PM is normally the leader of the majority party in the Lok Sabha.
- Some Members of the Rajya Sabha have been made Prime Minister.
- The PM holds office during the pleasure of the President.
- The President cannot dismiss the PM while he enjoys majority support in the Lok Sabha.
- If the PM loses the confidence of the Lok Sabha, he must resign or the President can dismiss him.
- The salary and allowances of the PM are determined by Parliament.
- The size of the Council of Ministers cannot exceed 15% of the total strength of the Lok Sabha (91st Amendment, 2003).
- A minister who is not in Parliament for six months will lose their position.
- Article 88 allows ministers to take part in both Houses but does not guarantee them voting rights.

Mnemonic - Conditions for dismissal of PM: PMR: Pleasure, Majority, Resign

P = PM holds office during the pleasure of the President; M = PM cannot be dismissed while he has Lok Sabha majority support; R = PM must resign if he loses the confidence of the Lok Sabha

Mind-map outline

Appointment, tenure and Council of Ministers

- Appointment
 - Normally leader of Lok Sabha majority
 - Two or more parties if no majority
- Tenure
 - Held during pleasure of President
 - Resign if Lok Sabha confidence lost
- Council of Ministers
 - 15% Lok Sabha size cap
 - Six-month rule for non-members

Modi's Firsts and Records in Context

Modi is the first Indian PM born after 15 August 1947 and the longest-serving PM from outside the Indian National Congress. He is among the few Indian PMs to secure three consecutive electoral mandates at the Union level. In 2014, the BJP-led NDA won an absolute majority of 336 out of 543 Lok Sabha seats, which the booklet calls the first Non-Congress single party majority government.

- Modi is the first Indian PM born after 15 August 1947.

- Modi is the longest-serving PM from outside the Indian National Congress.
- Modi is among the few Indian PMs to secure 3 consecutive electoral mandates at the Union level.
- Modi is the 3rd PM after Nehru and Indira Gandhi to serve 3 terms.
- In 2014, the BJP-led NDA got an absolute majority of 336 out of 543 Lok Sabha seats.
- The 2014 government is described as the first Non-Congress single party majority government.
- The BJP became the first party since 1984 to get a majority in the Lok Sabha.
- Morarji Desai was India's first Non-Congress PM and its oldest PM at 81 years.
- Rajiv Gandhi was India's youngest PM at 40 years.
- V.P. Singh was the first PM to leave office following a no-confidence vote.

Mind-map outline

Modi's firsts and records

- First PM born after Independence
- Longest-serving non-Congress PM
- Three consecutive electoral mandates
- 2014: NDA won 336 of 543 seats
- BJP first party majority since 1984

Passport Is Not Proof of Citizenship

Passport as a Travel Document

The Ministry of External Affairs clarified on Passport Seva Divas (June 24) that an Indian Passport is primarily a Travel Document, not conclusive proof of citizenship. Courts treat it as strong evidence of nationality, while citizenship is decided on constitutional criteria. Section 20 of the Passports Act, 1967 allows passports to be issued to non-citizens in the public interest.

- Ministry of External Affairs clarified this on Passport Seva Divas (June 24)
- Indian Passport is primarily a Travel Document
- Passport is Strong Evidence of Nationality but not Conclusive Proof of Citizenship in legal disputes
- Maneka Gandhi vs Union of India (1978): passport recognised as a Travel Document subject to constitutional protections
- State of Andhra Pradesh vs Abdul Khader (1962): Supreme Court held passport as supporting evidence
- Citizenship depends on constitutional criteria, not on the passport
- Section 20, Passports Act 1967: Central Government may issue passports to non-citizens in public interest
- Section 20 has been used for stateless persons, certain Tibetan refugees and Sri Lankan Tamil refugees needing international travel

Mind-map outline

Passport as travel document

- Primarily a travel document
- Strong evidence of nationality
- Not conclusive proof of citizenship
- Section 20, Passports Act 1967
 - Non-citizens in public interest
 - Used for stateless and refugee travel
- Abdul Khader (1962): supporting evidence
- Maneka Gandhi (1978): constitutional protections

Identity Documents vs Citizenship

No single universal document conclusively proves Indian citizenship. Aadhaar shows identity and residence, a Voter ID shows electoral eligibility, and a Ration Card shows residence and welfare eligibility. Inclusion in the electoral roll creates a presumption of citizenship that only due legal process can displace.

- No single universal document conclusively proves Indian citizenship
- Aadhaar: proof of identity and residence, not citizenship
- Voter ID: establishes electoral eligibility, not citizenship
- Ration Card: indicates residence and eligibility for welfare benefits, not citizenship

- Lal Babu Hussein vs Electoral Registration Officer (1995): inclusion in electoral roll creates a presumption of citizenship
- That presumption can be displaced only through due legal process
- Citizenship Certificate is issued only to persons acquiring citizenship through registration or naturalisation
- Persons acquiring citizenship by birth or descent do not receive a Citizenship Certificate
- Sarbananda Sonowal vs Union of India (2005): burden of proving Indian citizenship lies on the person claiming it
- Deletion from electoral roll does not amount to loss of citizenship

Mind-map outline

Identity documents vs citizenship

- Aadhaar: identity and residence
- Voter ID: electoral eligibility
- Ration Card: residence and welfare
- Electoral roll: presumption of citizenship
- Citizenship certificate: registration or naturalisation

Constitution and Citizenship Act, 1955

Articles 5 to 11 of the Constitution decided who became a citizen at the commencement on January 26, 1950. The Citizenship Act, 1955 governs acquisition and loss of citizenship, and has been amended six times since 1986. India does not permit dual citizenship.

- Articles 5 to 11 (Part 2) of the Constitution deal with citizenship at commencement (January 26, 1950)
- Citizenship Act, 1955 governs acquisition and determination of citizenship
- Ways to acquire citizenship: birth, descent, registration, naturalisation, incorporation of territory
- Ways to lose citizenship: renunciation, termination, deprivation
- Citizenship Act amended six times since 1986: 1986, 1992, 2003, 2005, 2015 and 2019
- Citizenship (Amendment) Act 2003 shifted India's regime towards Jus Sanguinis and barred illegal migrants from acquiring citizenship
- Citizenship Rules 2003 envisaged a National Register of Indian Citizens
- Citizenship (Amendment) Act 2019 covers six communities from Pakistan, Afghanistan and Bangladesh who entered India on or before 31 December 2014
- Citizenship (Amendment) Act 2019 exempts these communities from prosecution under the Foreigners Act, 1946 and the Passport Act, 1920 for illegal entry or overstaying
- India does not permit dual citizenship

Mnemonic - Ways to lose citizenship: RTD: Renunciation, Termination, Deprivation

R = Renunciation; T = Termination; D = Deprivation

Mind-map outline

Citizenship law framework

- Articles 5-11: citizens at 26 Jan 1950
- Citizenship Act, 1955
 - Acquire: birth, descent, registration, naturalisation
 - Acquire: incorporation of territory
 - Lose: renunciation, termination, deprivation
- Amended six times since 1986
- Amendment 2003: Jus Sanguinis
- Amendment 2019: entry by 31 Dec 2014
- No dual citizenship

Assam Accord and NRC

The Assam agitation of 1979-1985, led by AASU and AAGSP against illegal immigration, ended with a Memorandum of Settlement signed on August 15, 1985. Clause 6 of the Assam Accord mandates safeguards for Assamese identity. A committee headed by Justice (Retd) Biplab Kumar Sarma made 67 recommendations, of which 57 have been approved by the Assam Cabinet.

- Assam agitation years: 1979-1985
- Agitation led by AASU and AAGSP against illegal immigration

- Tripartite Memorandum of Settlement signed on August 15, 1985 by Central Government, Assam Government and agitation leaders
- Clause 6 of Assam Accord: constitutional, legislative and administrative safeguards for Assamese identity and heritage
- Committee headed by Justice (Retd) Biplab Kumar Sarma submitted 67 recommendations
- 57 recommendations approved by Assam Cabinet; 10 remain under discussion with Centre
- AASU stands for All Assam Students' Union; AAGSP stands for All Assam Gana Sangram Parishad
- Assam NRC: applicants had to establish links with legacy records predating 24 March 1971
- NRC in Assam commenced in 2003 following an SC Order
- NRC in Assam: 1951

Mnemonic - Assam dates pair: 85 signed, 71 cut-off

85 = Memorandum of Settlement signed on August 15, 1985; 71 = NRC legacy records predate 24 March 1971

Mind-map outline

Assam Accord and NRC

- Agitation years: 1979-1985
- Led by AASU and AAGSP
- Memorandum of Settlement: 15 Aug 1985
- Clause 6: Assamese identity safeguards
- Biplab Sarma committee: 67 recommendations
- NRC: legacy records before 24 March 1971
- NRC process commenced 2003

Polity & Governance

Draft Rules for VB-G RAM G Act 2025

Objectives and Rural Infrastructure Linkage

VB-G RAM G is framed as a Rural Employment and Livelihood Programme that pairs wage employment with the creation of durable rural assets. Its objectives cover livelihood security, productive employment, rural infrastructure, climate resilience and local planning outcomes. Employment is linked to water conservation, rural connectivity and climate-resilient community assets, and planning is decentralised.

- VB-G RAM G stands for Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin).
- The Act is set to replace MGNREGA from July 2026.
- It combines wage employment with creation of durable rural assets and infrastructure.
- Objectives: livelihood security, productive employment, rural infrastructure, climate resilience, local planning outcomes.
- Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack Programme links employment with infrastructure creation.
- Assets created include water conservation assets, rural connectivity infrastructure, livelihood-supporting facilities and climate-resilient community assets.
- Mandatory preparation of Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans.
- Technology integration through the Yuktdhara Portal and integration with PM Gati Shakti.

Mind-map outline

Objectives and Infrastructure Linkage

- Objectives
 - Livelihood security
 - Productive employment
 - Rural infrastructure
 - Climate resilience and local planning
- Infrastructure assets
 - Water conservation assets
 - Rural connectivity infrastructure
 - Livelihood-supporting facilities
 - Climate-resilient community assets

Employment Guarantee and Season Pause

Guaranteed wage employment per rural household rises from 100 days to 125 days a year. Wages must be paid within 15 days of work completion. States may declare a cumulative 60-day no-work period during peak sowing and harvesting seasons to prevent labour shortages in agriculture.

- Guaranteed wage employment increased from 100 days to 125 days annually per rural household.
- Mandatory wage payment within 15 days of work completion.
- Agricultural Season Pause: States may declare a cumulative 60-day No-Work Period.
- The No-Work Period applies during peak sowing and harvesting seasons.
- Objective of the pause: prevent labour shortages in agriculture and balance farm labour demand with employment guarantee objectives.

Mnemonic - Work 125, Pay 15, Pause 60: Work 125, Pay 15, Pause 60

125 = Guaranteed wage employment days per rural household annually; 15 = Days within which wages are paid after work completion; 60 = Cumulative days of no-work period a State may declare in peak seasons

Mind-map outline

Employment Guarantee and Season Pause

- Guarantee: 125 days per rural household
- Payment within 15 days of work completion
- Season pause: cumulative 60-day no-work period
- Purpose: prevent agricultural labour shortages

Normative Allocation and Cost-Sharing

The Draft Rules replace MGNREGA's open-ended, demand-driven financing with a normative allocation formula based on devolution criteria recommended by the 16th Finance Commission. The formula weights GSDP distance at 42.5% and population at 17.5%, with other criteria at 10% each. Cost sharing is revised, with the Centre bearing 60% for general States and 90% for Northeastern and Himalayan States.

- Shift from MGNREGA's open-ended, demand-driven financing to a Normative Allocation Model.
- Central allocations follow a Normative Allocation Formula based on devolution criteria recommended by the 16th Finance Commission.
- The normative model promotes predictability in resource allocation.
- GSDP distance carries 42.5% weightage and measures the gap between a State's per capita income and that of the wealthiest States.
- Population carries 17.5% weightage and benefits States with larger populations and greater employment demand.
- Other criteria carry 10% weightage each.
- General States: Centre 60%, State 40%. Northeastern and Himalayan States: Centre 90%, State 10%.
- Expenditure beyond the approved normative allocation must be fully financed by the concerned State Government.
- Performance-linked funding begins from the 2nd year, based on timely wage payments, social audit compliance, public works completion rate and implementation efficiency.

Mnemonic - Allocation weightages: Gap first, People next, Ten each for Others

Gap = GSDP distance, weighted 42.5%; People = Population, weighted 17.5%; Ten each = Other criteria, each weighted 10%

Mind-map outline

Normative Allocation and Cost-Sharing

- Allocation formula
 - Based on 16th Finance Commission devolution criteria
 - GSDP distance weightage: 42.5%
 - Population weightage: 17.5%
 - Other criteria: 10% each
- Cost-sharing
 - General States: Centre 60%, State 40%
 - Northeastern and Himalayan: Centre 90%, State 10%
 - Excess over allocation: fully state-funded
- Performance funding

- Starts from 2nd year
- Timely wage payments
- Social audit compliance
- Public works completion rate
- Implementation efficiency

Governance and Transition

A 16-member National Level Steering Committee, chaired by the Union Rural Development Secretary, recommends State-wise allocations and monitors implementation. The Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council, chaired by the Union Minister for Rural Development, advises the Centre on policy. e-KYC verified MGNREGA Job Cards remain valid during the transition period.

- National Level Steering Committee has 16 members.
- The Steering Committee is chaired by the Union Rural Development Secretary.
- Members include State Government representatives, NITI Aayog officials and representatives of relevant Union Ministries.
- Steering Committee functions: recommend State-wise allocations, formulate operational standards, monitor implementation and compliance.
- Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council is chaired by the Union Minister for Rural Development.
- The Council advises the Centre on policy implementation, reviews programme performance and facilitates coordination.
- e-KYC verified MGNREGA Job Cards remain valid during the transition period.
- Workers subsequently receive Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards under the new framework.

Mind-map outline

Governance and Transition

- National Level Steering Committee
 - 16 members
 - Chaired by Union Rural Development Secretary
 - Recommends State-wise allocations
 - Monitors implementation and compliance
- Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council
 - Chaired by Union Minister for Rural Development
 - Advises Centre on policy implementation
- Transition
 - e-KYC verified MGNREGA job cards remain valid
 - Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards issued later

Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968

Party System and Types of Parties

Political parties are groups of like-minded individuals who voluntarily organise to gain political power through constitutional means and promote the national interest. The booklet compares three party systems and gives examples of national and state parties in India. Recognised parties are allotted symbols reserved for their use in their jurisdiction.

- Political party: group of like-minded individuals who voluntarily organise to gain political power through constitutional means
- Aim of parties: promote the national interest
- Three party systems: one party (China), two party (USA), multi-party (India)
- National parties (6) include AAP, BJP, INC, BSP and CPI-M among the examples
- State parties include DMK, AIADMK, Telugu Desam, Shiv Sena, Asom Gana Parishad and Mizo National Front
- Recognised national or state parties are allotted a symbol exclusively reserved for their use in their jurisdiction
- The cockroach-as-symbol debate drew attention to the framework governing election symbols

Mind-map outline

Party System

- Political party

- Like-minded individuals
- Constitutional means
- Promote national interest
- Three systems
 - One party: China
 - Two party: USA
 - Multi-party: India
- Recognised parties
 - National: e.g. BJP, INC
 - State: e.g. DMK, Shiv Sena

Criteria for Recognition

Parties are recognised as national or state parties on the basis of votes and seats won at general elections. The booklet sets separate criteria for each category, measured against valid votes polled and seats in the Lok Sabha or the legislative assembly.

- National party: secures 6% of valid votes in any 4 or more states at a general election to the LS or LA
- National party: wins 4 LS seats from one or more states
- National party: wins 2% of LS seats at a general election, from 3 states
- National party: recognised as a state party in 4 states
- State party: secures 6% of valid votes polled in the state at a GE to the LA and wins 2 LA seats
- State party: wins 3% of LA seats or 3 LA seats, whichever is more
- State party: secures 8% of total valid votes polled in the state at a GE to the LS or LA
- State party: secures 6% of valid votes polled in the state at a GE to the LS and wins 1 LS seat from the state
- State party: wins 1 LS seat for every 25 seats or fraction thereof allotted to the state

Mind-map outline

Recognition Criteria

- National party
 - 6% valid votes in 4+ states
 - 4 LS seats from one or more states
 - 2% LS seats from 3 states
 - State party in 4 states
- State party
 - 6% valid votes plus 2 LA seats
 - 3% LA seats or 3 seats
 - 8% valid votes in the state
 - 1 LS seat per 25 seats

1968 Order: Reserved and Free Symbols

The Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968 was issued by the Election Commission and provides the legal framework for reservation and allotment of symbols. It separates reserved symbols, held exclusively by recognised parties, from free symbols, open to registered unrecognised parties and independent candidates.

- The Order was issued by the Election Commission of India in 1968
- The Order provides the legal framework for reservation and allotment of election symbols
- The Order covers registration, recognition and derecognition of parties
- The Order covers classification of parties as national or state parties
- The Order covers resolution of disputes arising from party splits and mergers
- Reserved symbols are exclusively allotted to recognised national or state parties
- Free symbols are available to registered unrecognised parties and independent candidates
- Free symbols are allotted by the ECI from a notified list

Mnemonic - Who gets which symbol: Recognised get Reserved; the rest get Free

Reserved = Exclusively allotted to recognised national or state parties; Free = Available to registered unrecognised parties and independent candidates

Mind-map outline

1968 Order

- Covers
 - Registration and recognition of parties
 - Classification: national or state
 - Disputes from splits and mergers
- Reserved symbols
 - Recognised national or state parties
 - Exclusive use in jurisdiction
- Free symbols
 - Registered unrecognised parties
 - Independent candidates
 - Allotted from a notified list

Party Splits and ECI's Role

The ECI is the sole authority to adjudicate disputes arising from splits within recognised parties and from mergers. It applies organisational and legislative tests before deciding whether one faction keeps the name and symbol, whether the other must register separately, or whether the symbol is frozen. Two Supreme Court decisions, Sadiq Ali (1972) and Kanhaiyalal Omar (1986), shape how these tests and the Order are applied.

- The ECI is the sole authority empowered to adjudicate disputes from splits within recognised parties and from mergers
- Organisational wing test covers the party president, office bearers, and national and state executive members
- Legislative wing test covers elected MPs, MLAs and MLCs (where applicable)
- One faction may be recognised as the original party, retaining the name and symbol
- The other faction must register separately under a different name and symbol
- If neither faction shows a clear majority, ECI may freeze the original symbol and direct both groups to contest under new names and symbols
- During the 1969 split of the Indian National Congress, ECI recognised Congress (O) and Congress (R)
- If factions reunite later, they may approach ECI for restoration of the original name and symbol
- Sadiq Ali (1972): majority support in both wings is crucial; legislative majority alone is not the sole criterion
- Kanhaiyalal Omar (1986): the Symbols Order is a valid exercise of ECI's constitutional and statutory powers

Mnemonic - Three split outcomes: KRF: Keep, Register, Freeze

K = One faction is recognised as the original party and keeps the name and symbol; R = The other faction must register separately under a different name and symbol; F = Symbol frozen if neither faction shows a clear majority

Mind-map outline

Party Splits

- ECI as sole authority
 - Splits in recognised parties
 - Mergers of parties
- Tests applied
 - Organisational wing
 - Legislative wing
- Outcomes
 - One faction keeps name and symbol
 - Other faction registers separately
 - Symbol frozen without clear majority
- Precedents
 - Sadiq Ali (1972)
 - Kanhaiyalal Omar (1986)

Telegram Ban under Section 69A of IT Act 2000

Why Telegram was blocked

MeitY temporarily blocked Telegram in India under Section 69A of the IT Act, 2000, after criminal groups allegedly used its message-editing feature to target candidates of the NEET-UG 2026 Re-Examination. Fraudsters edited old messages after an exam had ended to create a false appearance of a pre-exam leak. The booklet also links rising cybercrime complaints to activities organised within Telegram groups.

- MeitY temporarily blocked Telegram in India under Section 69A of the IT Act, 2000.
- Criminal groups allegedly used message editing to target and defraud NEET-UG 2026 Re-Examination candidates.
- Fraudsters inserted fake exam papers into old messages after an exam had ended.
- This retroactive editing created a false appearance of a pre-exam leak.
- Hidden phone numbers and end-to-end encryption in secret chats make tracing malicious actors nearly impossible for investigators.
- Telegram hosts marketplaces for renting bank accounts used in money laundering, extortion and illegal gambling.
- Criminals use automated bots to distribute illegal content and coordinate large-scale activities with minimal manual effort.
- Government data shows a sharp rise in official cybercrime complaints linked to activities in Telegram groups.

Mind-map outline

Why Telegram was blocked

- Misuse of message editing
 - Retroactive edits of old messages
 - Fake exam papers inserted
- Privacy features
 - Hidden phone numbers
 - End-to-end encryption in secret chats
- Other criminal use
 - Bank-account rental marketplaces
 - Automated bots distribute illegal content
 - Rising cybercrime complaints

Section 69A and the blocking procedure

Section 69A, introduced in 2008, lets the Central Government or an officer it specially authorises direct any government agency or intermediary to block public access to online information. The booklet lists six grounds for blocking. Requests are examined under the IT (Blocking Rules), 2009 through an Inter-Ministerial Review Mechanism. A Designated Committee evaluates necessity and legality, and interim directions may be issued in urgent situations.

- Section 69A was introduced in 2008.
- The Central Government, or an officer it specially authorises, can direct blocking of online information.
- Directions may go to any government agency or intermediary to block public access.
- Six grounds: sovereignty and integrity of India; defence of India; security of State; friendly relations with foreign States; public order; prevention of incitement to cognisable offences.
- Requests for blocking are examined under the IT (Blocking Rules), 2009.
- The Blocking Rules use an Inter-Ministerial Review Mechanism.
- A Designated Committee evaluates necessity and legality before the proposed action is implemented.
- In urgent situations, Interim Blocking Directions may be issued before a Full Review, subject to subsequent examination.
- The booklet calls Section 69A the primary legal mechanism for restricting access to digital content and online platforms.

Mnemonic - Six grounds for blocking: Shall Defenders Stop Foreign Pressure Immediately
Shall = Sovereignty and integrity of India; Defenders = Defence of India; Stop = Security of State;
Foreign = Friendly relations with foreign States; Pressure = Public order; Immediately = Prevention of incitement to cognisable offences

Mind-map outline

Section 69A procedure

- Who can order blocking
 - Central Government
 - Specially authorised officer
- Six grounds
 - Sovereignty and integrity of India
 - Defence, security of State, public order
 - Friendly relations; incitement to offences
- Safeguards
 - Designated Committee review
 - Inter-Ministerial Review Mechanism
 - Interim directions in urgency

Constitutional basis and judicial review

Digital free speech is protected under Article 19(1)(a), while Article 19(2) allows reasonable restrictions. In *Shreya Singhal vs Union of India* (2015), the Supreme Court upheld Section 69A as a narrowly drawn provision and struck down the vague Section 66A. Later rulings from the Delhi and Karnataka High Courts dealt with disclosure of blocking orders and with the rights of foreign companies.

- Article 19(1)(a) protects digital free speech.
- Article 19(2) allows the State to impose reasonable restrictions on free speech.
- *Shreya Singhal vs Union of India* (2015): Supreme Court upheld Section 69A as a narrowly drawn provision.
- The same judgment struck down the vague Section 66A.
- *Tanul Thakur vs Union of India* (2022): Delhi High Court mandated disclosure of original blocking orders.
- *Tanul Thakur* challenged the blanket confidentiality of Rule 16.
- *X Corp vs Union of India* (2023): Karnataka High Court ruled that foreign companies cannot claim Article 19 rights to challenge blocking orders.

Mnemonic - Landmark cases in order: Shy Tigers Xplore

Shy = *Shreya Singhal* (2015): Section 69A upheld as narrowly drawn; Tigers = *Tanul Thakur* (2022): disclosure of original blocking orders mandated; Xplore = *X Corp* (2023): foreign companies cannot claim Article 19 rights to challenge blocking orders

Mind-map outline

Constitutional basis and judicial review

- Article 19(1)(a)
 - Protects digital free speech
- Article 19(2)
 - Allows reasonable restrictions
- Case law
 - *Shreya Singhal* (2015): 69A upheld
 - *Tanul Thakur* (2022): disclose blocking orders
 - *X Corp* (2023): foreign firms cannot claim Art. 19

Intermediary duties and Safe Harbour

The IT Rules, 2021 require intermediaries to appoint a Grievance Officer, a Chief Compliance Officer and a Nodal Contact Person, and to carry out monthly compliance reporting. Section 79(3)(b) allows certain ministries to issue takedown or blocking orders directly, implemented through the Sahyog Portal. Safe harbour under Section 79 protects intermediaries from liability for third-party content only while they meet their duties.

- IT Rules, 2021 require appointment of a Grievance Officer, Chief Compliance Officer and Nodal Contact Person.
- Intermediaries must carry out monthly compliance and transparency reporting.
- Unlawful content must be removed on government direction.
- Section 79(3)(b) allows certain ministries to directly issue takedown or blocking orders.
- Section 79(3)(b) orders are implemented through the Government's Sahyog Portal.

- Section 79 grants online intermediaries immunity from liability for third-party content (safe harbour).
- Safe harbour is available only if intermediaries exercise due diligence and comply with lawful government directions.
- Failure to comply can lead to loss of safe harbour protection under Section 79.

Mind-map outline

Intermediary duties and Safe Harbour

- IT Rules 2021
 - Grievance Officer
 - Chief Compliance Officer
 - Nodal Contact Person
 - Monthly transparency reports
- Section 79(3)(b)
 - Direct takedown or blocking orders
 - Implemented via Sahyog Portal
- Safe harbour
 - Immunity for third-party content
 - Requires due diligence
 - Lost on non-compliance

DPDP Act 2023 and privacy

The Supreme Court held in 2017 that privacy is a fundamental right under Article 21. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 makes data fiduciaries accountable and lets platforms collect only the data needed for the services users opt for. The Act defines three roles, allows penalties of up to 250 crore on data fiduciaries, and sets rules such as a 72-hour breach notification and a 3-year retention limit for certain platforms.

- In 2017 the Supreme Court held that privacy is a fundamental right under Article 21.
- A Data Fiduciary decides the purpose of processing personal data.
- A Data Processor processes data on behalf of the Data Fiduciary.
- A Data Principal is the individual whose data is processed.
- Platforms may collect only the data required for their functioning and for services users have opted for.
- A torch app does not need microphone or contact access.
- Penalties of up to 250 crore can be imposed on Data Fiduciaries.
- All data is categorised under three heads: general, sensitive and critical.
- Data breaches must be notified to the Data Protection Board within 72 hours.
- E-commerce, social media and gaming platforms must generally delete personal data after 3 years of user inactivity.

Mnemonic - Three heads of data: Good Students Care

Good = General data; Students = Sensitive data; Care = Critical data

Mind-map outline

DPDP Act 2023 and privacy

- Privacy foundation
 - Fundamental right under Article 21 (2017)
- Key roles
 - Data Fiduciary decides purpose
 - Data Processor acts for fiduciary
 - Data Principal is the individual
- Obligations and penalties
 - 72-hour breach notification
 - Annual impact assessments for significant fiduciaries
 - Penalties up to 250 crore

Economics

WPI Base Year Revision and Introduction of PPI

Wholesale Price Index (WPI) Basics

The Wholesale Price Index measures the average change in prices of goods traded at wholesale or producer level, before they reach final consumers. It is an important indicator of inflationary trends within the production and distribution chain. The Office of Economic Adviser compiles and releases it.

- Measures average change in prices of goods traded at wholesale or producer level
- Captures prices before goods reach final consumers
- Indicator of inflationary trends within the production and distribution chain
- Compiled and released by the Office of Economic Adviser
- Office of Economic Adviser works under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- Base year of the WPI before revision: 2011-12

Mind-map outline

Wholesale Price Index

- Measures average change in goods prices
 - Wholesale or producer level
 - Before reaching final consumers
- Released by Office of Economic Adviser
 - Under Dept for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- Indicator of production-chain inflation

Base Year Revision and Major Reforms

The Government of India has approved revising the WPI base year from 2011-12 to 2022-23. The revised series changes the number of items, moves energy commodities to a different category, adopts a new weighting method and a new treatment of missing data. These changes aim to reflect the producer side of the economy more accurately.

- Government of India approved revision of WPI base year from 2011-12 to 2022-23
- Number of items rises from 697 (WPI 2011-12) to 957 (WPI 2022-23)
- Renewable energy inclusion adds Solar Power, Wind Energy and Nuclear Electricity as new components
- Crude Petroleum and Natural Gas shifted from Primary Articles to Fuel and Power category
- Revised weights are derived directly from Gross Value of Output
- Earlier weights were based on Net Traded Value: Gross Value of Output + Imports - Exports
- New missing-data approach: Targeted Mean Imputation
- Previous missing-data approach: Carry-Forward Method, where missing prices were replaced by the last available price

Mnemonic - New renewable components: Sun, Wind, Nuclear (SWN)

S = Solar Power added as a new component; W = Wind Energy added as a new component; N = Nuclear Electricity added as a new component

Mind-map outline

Revised WPI series

- Base year 2011-12 to 2022-23
 - Items 697 to 957
- Renewables added
 - Solar, wind, nuclear electricity
- Energy reclassified
 - Crude petroleum, natural gas to Fuel and Power
- Weights
 - Gross Value of Output (producer view)
- Missing data
 - Targeted mean imputation (was carry-forward)

Producer Price Indices (PPIs)

For the first time, India will release dedicated Producer Price Indices with 2022-23 as base year. These indices track prices from the producer side and cover goods as well as services. Three indices are described: Output, Input and Service PPI.

- For the first time, dedicated PPIs will be released with 2022-23 as base year

- Output PPI measures prices received by producers for goods and services they sell
- Output PPI captures prices at factory gate or producer level, before taxes, trade margins and transportation costs
- Output PPI reflects producer earnings and is an early indicator of future inflationary pressures
- Input PPI measures prices paid by producers for inputs such as raw materials, intermediate goods and energy
- Input PPI tracks production cost pressures and supply-side inflation
- Service PPI measures prices received by service providers for services rendered
- Services covered: banking, securities transactions, insurance, pension fund management, railways, air passenger transport and telecommunications

Mnemonic - Three PPI types: Sell, Buy, Serve

Sell = Output PPI: prices received by producers for goods and services they sell; Buy = Input PPI: prices paid by producers for inputs used in production; Serve = Service PPI: prices received by service providers for services rendered

Mind-map outline

Producer Price Indices

- First release with 2022-23 base
 - Covers goods and services
- Output PPI
 - Prices received by producers
- Input PPI
 - Prices paid for production inputs
- Service PPI
 - Prices received by service providers

WPI and PPI Compared

The PPI differs from the WPI in scope, focus, perspective and purpose. The WPI is primarily about goods and market-level wholesale prices, while the PPI covers goods and services and looks at producer revenue and input costs. The new PPIs are introduced alongside the revised WPI series.

- WPI scope: primarily goods; PPI scope: goods and services
- WPI focus: wholesale price movements; PPI focus: producer-level price changes
- WPI perspective: market-level wholesale prices; PPI perspective: producer revenue and input costs
- WPI purpose: inflation monitoring; PPI purpose: comprehensive producer inflation analysis
- New PPIs are introduced alongside the revised WPI series
- Service PPI captures inflation trends in the services sector from the producer perspective

Mind-map outline

WPI vs PPI

- Scope
 - WPI: primarily goods
 - PPI: goods and services
- Perspective
 - WPI: market-level wholesale prices
 - PPI: producer revenue and input costs
- Purpose
 - WPI: inflation monitoring
 - PPI: producer inflation analysis

Summits, Reports, Indices

G7 Summit 2026

52nd G7 Summit 2026

The 52nd G7 Summit was held in Evian-les-Bains, France, under France's presidency, with the theme 'Forging New Partnerships and Rebuilding International Solidarity'. PM Modi participated in the Outreach Session, which marked India's 8th consecutive participation in the G7 Outreach Process. The rotating presidency is due to pass to the United States in 2027.

- 52nd G7 Summit held in Evian-les-Bains, France

- Held under the French presidency
- Theme 2026: Forging New Partnerships and Rebuilding International Solidarity
- PM Modi participated in the 52nd G7 Summit Outreach Session
- India's 8th consecutive participation in the G7 Outreach Process
- Rotating presidency to hand over to the United States in 2027

Mind-map outline

52nd G7 Summit 2026

- Where and when
 - Evian-les-Bains, France
 - 52nd edition
- Theme and presidency
 - Forging New Partnerships theme
 - Presidency: France
 - Handover to United States in 2027
- India's role
 - PM Modi at Outreach Session
 - 8th consecutive Outreach participation

Evolution of the G7

The G7 was established in 1975 in response to global economic turbulence and an oil crisis, with six founding members. Canada joined in 1976, creating the G7, and Russia joined in 1998, leading to the formation of the G8. Russia's participation was suspended in 2014 following the annexation of Crimea, which restored the G7 format.

- Established in 1975 amid global economic turbulence and oil crisis
- Founding members: France, West Germany, Italy, Japan, United Kingdom, United States
- Canada joined in 1976, creating the G7
- Russia joined in 1998, leading to the formation of the G8
- Russia's participation suspended in 2014 after annexation of Crimea
- Suspension restored the G7 format

Mnemonic - G7 chronology: Seventy-five Started it, Canada Came Next, Ninety-eight Brought Russia, Fourteen Restored the format

Seventy-five = Grouping established in 1975; Canada Came Next = Canada joined in 1976, creating the G7; Ninety-eight = Russia joined in 1998, leading to the G8; Fourteen = Russia's participation suspended in 2014, restoring the G7 format

Mind-map outline

Evolution of the G7

- Origins (1975)
 - Response to economic turbulence
 - Response to oil crisis
 - Six founding members
- Expansion
 - 1976: Canada joined
 - 1998: Russia joined, G8 formed
- Restoration
 - 2014: Russia suspended
 - Annexation of Crimea cited
 - G7 format restored

Membership and Structure

The G7 is an informal forum of some of the world's most advanced industrialised economies, serving as a platform for consultations on major economic, political and strategic issues. It has seven member countries, while the European Union takes part in deliberations without being counted as a formal member. Leadership of the group rotates annually among member states.

- Informal forum of the world's most advanced industrialised economies
- Member countries: Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, UK, US
- European Union participates in deliberations but is not a formal member
- Accounts for around 10% of the world's population

- Accounts for nearly 43% of global GDP
- Leadership rotates annually among member states

Mind-map outline

Membership and Structure

- Members
 - Seven formal member countries
 - Canada, France, Germany, Italy
 - Japan, UK, United States
- Nature
 - Informal forum
 - Platform for consultations
 - Advanced industrialised economies
- Scale
 - Around 10% of world population
 - Nearly 43% of global GDP
- Leadership
 - Rotating presidency
 - Rotates annually among members

Pillars of G7 Influence

The booklet describes the G7's influence through several pillars, including shaping financial regulation, responding to crises, and coordinating on energy and geopolitical issues. The forum is also presented as a symbol of cooperation among major economies and as a catalyst for climate and humanitarian commitments. Its dialogue is described as a way to find common ground on complex global challenges.

- Summit discussions affect financial regulations and economic frameworks used worldwide
- Enables a unified front when addressing economic crises, armed conflicts and public health emergencies
- Leaders coordinate on energy insecurity and geopolitical instability
- Collective decisions influence global trade policies, investment flows and economic recovery strategies
- Primary symbol of cooperation among the world's major economies
- Commitments serve as a catalyst for climate action and humanitarian assistance
- Dialogue and coordination help find common ground on complex global challenges

Mnemonic - Pillars of influence: Regulators Can Secure Trade

R = Regulatory influence on financial regulations and economic frameworks; C = Collective response to economic crises, armed conflicts and health emergencies; S = Securing the future through action on energy insecurity and geopolitical instability; T = Collective decisions influence global trade policies and investment flows

Mind-map outline

Pillars of G7 Influence

- Economic influence
 - Financial regulation frameworks
 - Global trade policies
 - Investment flows
- Crisis response
 - Economic crises
 - Armed conflicts
 - Public health emergencies
- Security
 - Energy insecurity
 - Geopolitical instability
- Cooperation
 - Symbol of major-economy cooperation
 - Dialogue for common ground
- Global frameworks
 - Climate action
 - Humanitarian assistance
 - Governance evolution

Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting 2026

Origins and Core Objectives

The Quad grew out of humanitarian cooperation after the 2004 Indian Ocean Tsunami and its concept was championed by Shinzo Abe in 2007. The grouping was revitalised in 2017 amid concerns over China's expanding military and economic influence. It remains an informal strategic partnership of India, the United States, Japan and Australia.

- Quad foundations emerged through humanitarian cooperation after the 2004 Indian Ocean Tsunami.
- The Quad concept was championed by former Japanese PM Shinzo Abe in 2007.
- The grouping was revitalised in 2017 amid concerns over China's expanding military and economic influence.
- Quad stands for Quadrilateral Security Dialogue.
- Members: India, United States, Japan and Australia.
- It is an informal strategic partnership, enabling cooperation without a formal military alliance.
- Core objective: a Free, Open, Inclusive, Secure and Prosperous Indo-Pacific.
- Principles: rule of law, freedom of navigation, territorial integrity, peaceful resolution of disputes.

Mind-map outline

Origins and Core Objectives

- Origins
 - 2004 tsunami: humanitarian cooperation
 - 2007: Abe championed concept
 - 2017: revitalised
- Core objective
 - Free, Open, Inclusive, Secure, Prosperous
 - Rule of law, freedom of navigation
- Nature
 - Informal strategic partnership
 - Quadrilateral Security Dialogue

Maritime and Security Cooperation

Maritime cooperation is one strand of the 11th meeting's outcomes. The outcomes include a surveillance framework that uses tracking assets of all members and a partnership for near real-time maritime data. Security work also covers the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission, the Malabar Exercise and a counterterrorism tabletop exercise.

- Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Collaboration uses tracking and monitoring assets of all Quad members.
- Immediate focus area of maritime surveillance: the Indian Ocean Region.
- Maritime surveillance objective: strengthen maritime domain awareness and monitor illicit maritime activities.
- Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness enables near real-time maritime data sharing across regional waters.
- Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission was launched under the Wilmington Declaration.
- Quad-at-Sea objective: improve naval coordination, enhance interoperability, counter illegal maritime activities.
- India will host the next edition of the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission.
- Malabar Exercise is an annual multilateral naval exercise of Quad members.
- Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise focuses on state-sponsored terrorism, UAV threats and joint crisis response planning; to be hosted by Australia in 2026.

Mnemonic - Maritime tools: Surveil, Share, Observe, Drill

Surveil = Maritime surveillance framework using tracking assets of all members; Share = Near real-time maritime data sharing across regional waters; Observe = Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission; Drill = Malabar Exercise, an annual multilateral naval exercise

Mind-map outline

Maritime and Security Cooperation

- Surveillance and data
 - Tracking assets of all members

- Near real-time maritime data sharing
- Naval activity
 - Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission
 - Malabar Exercise: annual
- Security exercise
 - Counterterrorism tabletop, hosted by Australia 2026

Economic Security and Emerging Technologies

The Quad's economic agenda centres on critical minerals, energy security and supply-chain resilience. Its infrastructure and technology work covers Pacific island connectivity, digital identity interoperability and AI-driven agriculture. Several initiatives aim to diversify sources beyond dominant suppliers.

- Quad Critical Minerals Initiative Framework coordinates investments and policies on mining, processing and recycling of critical minerals.
- Critical minerals significance: reduce supply-chain vulnerabilities and diversify sources beyond dominant suppliers.
- Indo-Pacific Energy Security Initiative launched a Joint Regional Energy Roadmap with commitment of over USD 25 million.
- Energy focus areas: energy technology integration, supply chain resilience and market risk assessment.
- Pacific Island Infrastructure Outreach is a collaboration with Fiji.
- Outreach goals: connect all Pacific Island Forum countries through resilient undersea cable networks and modernise port infrastructure.
- Outreach target: completion by 2026.
- Digital Identity Interoperability involves developing a technical 'Translation Guide' for digital identity systems.
- AI-ENGAGE Initiative aims to enhance agricultural productivity and food security across the Indo-Pacific.

Mnemonic - Economic memory aid: Mighty Energy Pulls Tech

Mighty = Quad Critical Minerals Initiative Framework; Energy = Indo-Pacific Energy Security Initiative, over USD 25 million; Pulls = Pacific Island Infrastructure Outreach, collaboration with Fiji; Tech = Translation Guide for digital identity systems

Mind-map outline

Economic Security and Emerging Technologies

- Minerals and energy
 - Critical minerals: mining, processing, recycling
 - Energy roadmap: over USD 25 million
- Pacific islands
 - Outreach with Fiji
 - Undersea cable networks and ports
- Technology
 - Translation Guide for digital identity
 - AI-ENGAGE: agriculture and food security

Significance for India and the Global Order

The Quad is presented as a strategic counterbalance that opposes unilateral attempts to alter the status quo. For India, it helps balance China's growing maritime presence, improve monitoring of maritime activity and attract investment. Its technology and supply-chain work also supports diversification under the China+1 strategy.

- Strategic counterbalance: supports freedom of navigation and opposes unilateral attempts to alter the status quo.
- Supply-chain resilience supports diversification under the China+1 strategy.
- Technology cooperation covers AI, cybersecurity, 5G/6G, Open RAN networks and secure digital infrastructure.
- Quad provides regional public goods: disaster relief, health security, infrastructure support and capacity building.

- For India, the Quad balances China's growing maritime presence and String of Pearls strategy in the Indian Ocean.
- For India, the Quad preserves strategic autonomy without entering a formal military alliance.
- For India, the Quad enhances monitoring of maritime activities and detection of illegal fishing and grey-zone tactics.
- Blue Dot Network and the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative helped India attract foreign investment and integrate into global value chains.

Mind-map outline

Significance for India and the Global Order

- Balancing China
 - Strategic counterbalance
 - String of Pearls in Indian Ocean
- India's gains
 - Maritime monitoring and grey-zone detection
 - Blue Dot Network and investment
- Global role
 - China+1 supply-chain diversification
 - Regional public goods

Environment & Disaster Management

E85 Fuel Rollout in India

Ethanol and E85 Basics

Ethanol is a highly purified alcohol that is blended with petrol to make transport fuel. E85 is a blend of 85% ethanol and 15% petrol, and it can be used only in Flex-Fuel Vehicles. The Ethanol Blending Programme is overseen by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

- Ethanol is highly purified alcohol with approximately 99.9% purity.
- Major feedstocks for ethanol are sugarcane, maize, wheat and other sugar- and starch-rich crops.
- Ethanol blending means mixing ethanol with petrol to create fuel for internal combustion engines.
- E85 is a fuel blend of 85% ethanol and 15% petrol (gasoline).
- E85 can be used only in Flex-Fuel Vehicles built to run on varying ethanol-petrol blends.
- The Ethanol Blending Programme was piloted in 2003 and later expanded under the National Policy on Biofuels (2018).
- The Ethanol Blending Programme targeted 20% ethanol blending (E20) by 2030, achieved in 2025.
- Nodal ministry for the Ethanol Blending Programme is the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.
- Ethanol and biodiesel are the most common biofuels.

Mind-map outline

Ethanol and E85 Basics

- Ethanol
 - Highly purified alcohol, about 99.9%
 - Feedstocks: sugarcane, maize, wheat
- Blending
 - Mixed with petrol for transport fuel
 - Fuel for internal combustion engines
- E85
 - 85% ethanol, 15% petrol
 - Only Flex-Fuel Vehicles
- Programme
 - Nodal ministry: Petroleum and Natural Gas
 - E20 target achieved in 2025

Benefits of Ethanol Blending

Ethanol blending is promoted for energy security, environmental gains and farm incomes. It cuts crude oil imports and gives a buffer against price shocks. It also turns agro-waste into fuel and encourages maize over sugarcane.

- Import reduction: ethanol cuts India's dependence on crude oil imports.
- Blending buffer: ethanol stockpiles give flexibility for price stabilisation against crude oil shocks.

- Lifecycle emissions: 2G ethanol reduces GHG emissions by over 50% compared to petrol.
- Agro-waste utilisation: stubble, dung and biomass are converted into fuel, supporting a circular economy.
- Farmer income: since 2014, farmers have earned about 21 lakh crore through ethanol procurement transfers.
- Crop diversification: promotes maize cultivation and reduces over-dependence on sugarcane.
- Objectives include reducing crude oil imports and providing assured markets for farmers.

Mind-map outline

Benefits of Ethanol Blending

- Energy and economy
 - Cuts crude oil imports
 - Stockpiles buffer price shocks
- Environment
 - Over 50% lower GHG (2G)
 - Stubble and dung turned into fuel
- Farmers
 - Income from ethanol procurement
 - Maize grown over sugarcane

Concerns with Ethanol Blending

A survey finds that many petrol vehicle owners report reduced mileage and higher maintenance costs. Water-intensive sugarcane and land degradation are listed as environmental concerns.

Diverting rice and corn for ethanol raises food-versus-fuel questions.

- A survey finds 67% of petrol vehicle owners report reduced mileage and higher maintenance costs.
- Sugarcane has a high water requirement of 60-70 tonnes per tonne.
- Water-intensive sugarcane drives groundwater depletion.
- Unsustainable farming causes degradation of nearly 30% of India's land.
- Diverting rice and corn for ethanol production raises food-versus-fuel concerns.
- Imports and food security concerns are listed as a further issue.

Mind-map outline

Concerns with Ethanol Blending

- Vehicles
 - 67% report reduced mileage
 - Higher maintenance costs
- Water and land
 - Sugarcane: 60-70 tonnes per tonne
 - Groundwater depletion
 - Nearly 30% of land degraded
- Food
 - Food vs fuel diversion
 - Food security concerns

Biofuel Generations

Biofuels are grouped into generations by their feedstock and their carbon impact. First-generation fuels use edible items, while second-generation fuels use leftovers of food crops. Third- and fourth-generation fuels use microorganisms and genetically engineered crops.

- 1st generation biofuel is made from edible items such as sugar, corn and starch, and has high carbon content.
- 2nd generation biofuel is made from leftovers of food crops such as rice husk and wood chips.
- 2nd generation biofuel has lower greenhouse gas content than 1st generation biofuel.
- 3rd generation biofuel is produced using microorganisms such as algae and is carbon neutral.
- 4th generation biofuel is made from genetically engineered crops and is carbon negative.
- The National Policy on Biofuels includes production of 2G ethanol as a key element.
- A 2G ethanol project is located at Panipat, Haryana.

Mnemonic - Four generations cue: Edible, Leftover, Microbial, Engineered

Edible = 1st generation: made from edible items such as sugar, corn and starch; Leftover = 2nd generation: made from leftovers of food crops; Microbial = 3rd generation: produced using

microorganisms such as algae; Engineered = 4th generation: made from genetically engineered crops

Mind-map outline

Biofuel Generations

- 1st generation
 - Edible items: sugar, corn, starch
 - High carbon content
- 2nd generation
 - Food-crop leftovers: rice husk, wood chips
 - Lower GHG than 1st
- 3rd generation
 - Made using microorganisms such as algae
 - Carbon neutral
- 4th generation
 - Genetically engineered crops
 - Carbon negative

Policies, Schemes and Alliances

The National Policy on Biofuels aims to reduce import dependence through blending. Schemes such as PM JI-VAN Yojana and GOBAR-DHAN support 2G ethanol and waste-to-energy conversion. India also launched the Global Biofuels Alliance with partner countries in 2023.

- National Policy on Biofuels (2018) aims to reduce import dependence by blending bioethanol, biodiesel and Bio-CNG.
- PM JI-VAN Yojana (2019) gives financial assistance for developing 2G ethanol from surplus biomass and agricultural waste.
- GOBAR-DHAN Scheme (2018) converts cattle dung and solid waste into compost, biogas and bio-CNG.
- GOBAR-DHAN was launched under the Swachh Bharat Mission (Gramin).
- Repurpose Used Cooking Oil (RUCO) was launched by FSSAI to convert used cooking oil into biodiesel.
- BioE3 Policy aims to set up Bio-Foundries that produce biotechnology-developed feedstock and catalysts.
- The Cabinet approved a Hydrogen Mission on 04 January 2023 with an outlay of Rs. 19,744 crore.
- The Global Biofuels Alliance was launched in 2023 by India on the sidelines of the G20 Summit in New Delhi.
- The Global Biofuels Alliance aims to facilitate global biofuel trade and provide technical support for national programmes.

Mnemonic - Three Es of BioE3: Three Es: Economy, Environment, Employment

Economy = BioE3 stands for Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment; Environment = Second E in the BioE3 expansion; Employment = Third E in the BioE3 expansion

Mind-map outline

Policies, Schemes and Alliances

- National Policy on Biofuels (2018)
 - Cuts import dependence
 - Blends bioethanol, biodiesel, Bio-CNG
- Schemes
 - PM JI-VAN Yojana (2019): 2G ethanol aid
 - GOBAR-DHAN (2018): dung to bio-CNG
 - RUCO: used cooking oil to biodiesel
- BioE3 and Hydrogen
 - Bio-foundries; enzyme plant at Manesar
 - Hydrogen Mission: Rs 19,744 crore
- Global Biofuels Alliance
 - Launched 2023 at G20 Summit
 - Aims: global trade, technical support

World Environment Day 2026

World Environment Day and UNEP

World Environment Day is celebrated every year on June 5 and was established in 1972 to coincide with the opening of the Stockholm Conference on Human Environment. It is organised by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), which is based in Nairobi, Kenya. The 2026 edition carried the theme 'Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.' and named Azerbaijan as Global Host.

- World Environment Day is celebrated on June 5 every year.
- Established in 1972 to coincide with the opening of the Stockholm Conference on Human Environment.
- Celebrated in 1973 with the theme 'Only One Earth'.
- Organised by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).
- UNEP was founded in 1972 and is based in Nairobi, Kenya.
- Purpose: raise awareness and drive global action on pressing environmental issues.
- WED 2026 theme: 'Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.'
- Azerbaijan was named Global Host for World Environment Day 2026.

Mind-map outline

World Environment Day and UNEP

- Celebrated June 5 each year
 - Established 1972
 - Coincided with Stockholm Conference
- Organised by UNEP
 - UNEP founded 1972
 - Based in Nairobi, Kenya
- Purpose: awareness and global action
- 2026 Global Host: Azerbaijan

Global Climate Finance and the Tropical Forest Facility

The New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) on climate finance was formally established at COP29 in Baku. It sets a target to scale up climate funding for developing nations to at least \$1.3 trillion per year by 2035, with developed nations leading the mobilisation of at least \$300 billion annually. The Tropical Forest Forever Facility was officially launched at COP30 in Belem, Brazil, to make standing forests more valuable than cleared land.

- The NCQG on climate finance was formally established at COP29 in Baku.
- Target: scale up climate funding to developing nations to at least \$1.3 trillion per year by 2035.
- Developed nations agreed to lead mobilisation of at least \$300 billion annually by 2035.
- The Baku-Belem Roadmap to 1.3T designed an institutional mechanism spanning the Azerbaijan and Brazil Presidencies.
- The Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF) was officially launched at COP30 in Belem, Brazil.
- COP30 in Belem is widely termed the 'Amazon Forest COP'.
- TFFF makes standing, living tropical forests more economically valuable than cleared land.
- TFFF directly addresses the financial drivers of deforestation.

Mind-map outline

Climate Finance and TFFF

- NCQG
 - Formed at COP29, Baku
 - \$1.3 trillion per year by 2035
 - \$300 billion from developed nations
- Baku-Belem Roadmap
 - Spans Azerbaijan and Brazil Presidencies
- TFFF
 - Launched at COP30, Belem
 - Makes standing forests valuable
 - Targets financial drivers of deforestation

India's Climate Targets and the Solar Alliance

India's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) set targets on emissions intensity, non-fossil power capacity and carbon sinks, and the updated NDC submitted in 2022 raised the 2030 goals. The status column shows that the 2030 non-fossil target had reached 52.57% by February 2026. The International Solar Alliance, launched by India and France in 2015, was officially established in December 2017.

- First NDC (submitted 2015): cut emissions intensity of GDP by 33-35% from 2005 levels by 2030.
- Updated NDC (submitted 2022): cut emissions intensity of GDP by 45% by 2030.
- Non-fossil fuel based installed electric power capacity: 40% by 2030 (first NDC), 50% (updated NDC).
- First NDC: additional carbon sink of 2.5-3 billion tonnes CO₂ equivalent by 2030 through forest and tree cover.
- Status: 36% reduction in emissions intensity achieved by 2020.
- Status: 52.57% non-fossil fuel based installed capacity achieved by February 2026.
- Status: 2.29 billion tonnes CO₂ equivalent additional carbon sink achieved by 2021.
- International Solar Alliance (ISA) jointly launched by India and France in 2015 on the sidelines of COP-21 in Paris.
- ISA was officially established on 6 December 2017, on the entry into force of the Framework Agreement.
- ISA covers solar resource-rich states lying fully or partially between the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn.

Mind-map outline

NDCs and Solar Alliance

- First NDC (2015)
 - 33-35% emissions intensity cut by 2030
 - 40% non-fossil capacity by 2030
- Updated NDC (2022)
 - 45% emissions intensity cut by 2030
 - 50% non-fossil capacity
- Status
 - 52.57% non-fossil by Feb 2026
 - 36% intensity cut by 2020
 - 2.29 billion tonnes CO₂e sink by 2021
- ISA
 - Launched by India and France, 2015
 - Established 6 December 2017

Forest, Wetland and Restoration Drives in India

India runs several land-based programmes to expand and protect green cover. The National Mission for Green India aims to add forest and tree cover on 5 million hectares and improve quality on another 5 million hectares. The Aravalli Green Wall is a planned 1,400 km by 5 km green belt from Porbandar (Gujarat) to Panipat (Haryana), intended to halt desertification from the Thar Desert.

- National Mission for Green India (2014) is one of 8 missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change.
- Green India Mission: increase forest/tree cover on 5 million hectares and improve quality on another 5 million hectares.
- CAMPA funds promote afforestation and regeneration on waste, vacant and barren lands.
- India expanded its Ramsar Site count to 100 as of now.
- India ranks 3rd globally in net forest area gain over the past 15 years.
- Project Tiger was launched in 1973 and Project Elephant in 1992.
- MISHTI (Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats and Tangible Incomes) was announced in Union Budget 2023-24.
- Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam: plant trees in memory of one's mother, linking emotional appeal with afforestation.
- Aravalli Green Wall: 1,400 km x 5 km green belt from Porbandar (Gujarat) to Panipat (Haryana), inspired by Africa's Great Green Wall.

- Aravalli purposes: halt desertification from the Thar Desert, restore degraded lands, improve air quality, biodiversity and climate resilience.

Mnemonic - Green India five-five-eight: Five to grow, five to mend, eight missions under the climate plan
 Five to grow = 5 million hectares for increasing forest and tree cover; Five to mend = 5 million hectares for improving the quality of forest and tree cover; Eight = Number of missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change

Mind-map outline

Forest, Wetland and Restoration

- Green India Mission
 - One of 8 NAPCC missions
 - 5 million ha to expand cover
 - 5 million ha to improve quality
- Wetlands
 - Ramsar sites: 100
- Wildlife
 - Project Tiger, 1973
 - Project Elephant, 1992
- Mangroves
 - MISHTI, Union Budget 2023-24
- Aravalli Green Wall
 - 1,400 km x 5 km belt
 - Porbandar to Panipat
- Citizen action
 - Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam

Plastic Pollution, Cleanliness and Mission LiFE

Governments are negotiating an internationally legally binding instrument to end plastic pollution, through an Intergovernmental Negotiating Committee (INC) that has met in several cities since 2022. India's own efforts include the Swachh Bharat Abhiyan, launched in 2014, and Mission LiFE, first introduced in 2021. Industry and project-level initiatives such as the India Plastics Pact and Project REPLAN add to these efforts.

- Negotiators are developing an internationally legally binding instrument to end plastic pollution worldwide.
- INC sessions: Punta del Este, Uruguay (2022); Paris, France (2023); Nairobi, Kenya (2023); Ottawa, Canada (May 2024).
- Swachh Bharat Abhiyan was launched by the PM on Gandhi Jayanti, 2 October 2014, in New Delhi.
- Swachh Bharat aimed for a 'Clean India' by 2 October 2019, the 150th birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi.
- Bangladesh was the first country to ban thin plastic bags.
- India Plastics Pact was launched in collaboration with the Confederation of Indian Industries (CII) and WWF.
- Project REPLAN (REducing PLAstic in Nature) was launched by the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC).
- REPLAN process: waste plastic is collected, cleaned, chopped, beaten and treated for softness.
- Mission LiFE is an India-led global mass movement for protecting and preserving the environment.
- Mission LiFE was first introduced in 2021 by PM Modi at COP26 in Glasgow, and aims to mobilise at least 1 billion people for 2022-2027.

Mnemonic - REPLAN letters: RE-PLA-N: Reduce the PLAstic that ends up in Nature
 RE = REducing; PLA = PLAstic; N = in Nature

Mind-map outline

Plastics and Cleanliness

- Plastic treaty (INC)
 - INC-1 Punta del Este (2022)
 - INC-2 Paris (2023)
 - INC-3 Nairobi (2023)
 - INC-4 Ottawa (May 2024)
- Swachh Bharat (2014)

- Launched 2 October, New Delhi
- Goal: Clean India by 2019
- Mission LiFE (2021)
 - Introduced at COP26, Glasgow
 - 1 billion people target, 2022-2027
- REPLAN
 - Launched by KVIC
 - Waste plastic chopped, beaten, treated
- India Plastics Pact
 - Launched with CII and WWF
- Bangladesh
 - First to ban thin plastic bags

Miscellaneous

Miscellaneous

Economy, Logistics and Infrastructure

This group covers the April 2026 Index of Industrial Production (IIP) and the revised IIP series with 2022-23 as the new base year. It also covers the Logistics Port Performance Index for FY 2024-25 and the Zojila Tunnel on the Srinagar-Leh highway. IIP tracks short-term changes in industrial output, while the port index measures operational efficiency across cargo categories.

- IIP growth was 4.9% in April 2026, lower than 5.8% in April 2025.
- Manufacturing, about 76% of IIP weight, expanded by 6.2% in April 2026.
- Mining and quarrying contracted by more than 5% in April 2026.
- The revised IIP series uses 2022-23 as base year, replacing 2011-12.
- The revised series covers 1,042 products (earlier 839) and 463 item groups (earlier 407).
- The revised series adds gas supply, water supply, sewerage and waste management activities.
- Logistics Port Performance Index FY 2024-25: Paradip Port tops dry bulk, Sikka Port tops liquid bulk.
- Port KPIs include vessel turnaround time, berth idle time, container dwell time and ship berth day output.
- World Bank LPI: India's rank in the international shipments category improved from 44 to 22.
- Zojila Tunnel is 13.15 km long, expected to be operational in 2028, and is part of a 33 km corridor.

Mind-map outline

Economy, Logistics and Infrastructure

- IIP
 - April 2026 growth 4.9%
 - Manufacturing 6.2%, mining down over 5%
 - Base year 2022-23
- Logistics Port Performance Index
 - Dry bulk: Paradip Port
 - Liquid bulk: Sikka Port
 - World Bank LPI rank 44 to 22
- Zojila Tunnel
 - Length 13.15 km
 - Expected operational 2028

Environment, Energy and Space

The Western Ghats are set to get Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) notification, based largely on the Kasturirangan Committee's 2013 recommendations. The group also covers GRAPES-3, an India-Japan study of Earth's upper atmosphere, and the Energy Transition Index 2026 that ranks 120 countries.

- The government is set to notify ESAs in the Western Ghats, nearly 13 years after the first draft notification.
- The notification is based largely on the K. Kasturirangan Committee (2013) recommendations.
- The Kasturirangan approach covers about 56,000 sq km, about 37% of the Western Ghats.

- The Western Ghats extend about 1,600 km along the west coast across six states and are a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- New mining and quarrying projects, thermal power plants and red category industries are restricted in ESAs.
- GRAPES-3 is a cosmic-ray observatory at Ooty (Tamil Nadu), operated by the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research.
- Researchers from India and Japan used GRAPES-3 to track real-time changes in Earth's upper atmosphere.
- The Energy Transition Index 2026 (WEF and Accenture) assesses 120 countries; India moved up two places to 70th.
- Six G20 countries are in the Energy Transition Index top 20: Germany 9th, France 10th, UK 11th, China 14th, Brazil 17th, USA 19th.

Mind-map outline

Environment, Energy and Space

- Western Ghats ESA
 - Based on Kasturirangan Committee 2013
 - About 56,000 sq km coverage
 - Restricts new mining and thermal plants
- GRAPES-3
 - Telescope at Ooty
 - Operated by TIFR
- Energy Transition Index 2026
 - 120 countries assessed
 - India ranks 70th

Defence and Security

This group covers the SIPRI Yearbook 2026 on global militarisation and India's nuclear posture, and the two councils of India's Nuclear Command Authority. It also covers the S-400 and BrahMos systems, other major air and missile defence systems, and a leadership change at the Intelligence Bureau.

- SIPRI Yearbook 2026 ranks India as the 5th largest military spender after USA, China, Russia and Germany.
- India's defence expenditure rose 8.9% to USD 92.1 billion in 2025.
- India's nuclear arsenal reached 190 warheads, including 12 operationally deployed warheads.
- The Political Council (chaired by the Prime Minister) is the sole body authorised to release nuclear weapons.
- The Executive Council (chaired by the National Security Advisor) gives inputs to the Political Council and executes its directives.
- India's nuclear milestones: 1974 Pokhran test, 1998 Operation Shakti, 2003 nuclear doctrine, 2008 NSG waiver.
- India received the 4th squadron of S-400 Triumf from Russia; it is called Sudarshan in Indian service.
- BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile (Mach 2.8), jointly developed by DRDO and NPOM, and is conventional only; it was used in combat during Operation Sindoor.
- Beaufort Castle, a Crusader-era fortress in southern Lebanon, was under Israeli control from the 1982 invasion until withdrawal in 2000.
- Mahesh Dixit was appointed Director of the Intelligence Bureau for a 2-year tenure, succeeding Tapan Kumar Deka.

Mnemonic - Nuclear Command Authority: Political PM, Executive NSA

Political = Political Council: chaired by the Prime Minister; sole body authorised to release nuclear weapons; Executive = Executive Council: chaired by the National Security Advisor; gives inputs and executes directives

Mind-map outline

Defence and Security

- SIPRI Yearbook 2026
 - Defence spend USD 92.1 billion
 - 190 warheads, 12 deployed
- Nuclear Command Authority

- Political Council: sole release authority
- Executive Council: inputs and execution
- Missile systems
 - S-400 called Sudarshan in India
 - BrahMos: Mach 2.8, conventional only

Governance, Global Bodies and Peacekeeping

This group covers the FCRA Amendment Rules 2026, which tighten compliance for NGOs receiving foreign contributions. It also covers the FATF grey and black lists, the US-led Pax Silica initiative, and India's role in UN Peacekeeping.

- The Ministry of Home Affairs notified the FCRA Amendment Rules 2026; the FCRA Act 2010 replaced the 1976 Act.
- NGOs must register under one or more of 5 approved categories: social, economic, educational, cultural and religious.
- FCRA registration is valid for 5 years and must be renewed before expiry; foreign contributions cannot be transferred to other persons or organisations.
- NGOs must utilise at least 75% of previously released foreign funds before receiving the next instalment.
- FATF was created in 1989 by the G7 and is headquartered in Paris; Vivek Aggarwal was appointed its next Vice-President, the first time India will hold that post.
- FATF grey list covers jurisdictions under increased monitoring; the black list covers high-risk jurisdictions.
- Pax Silica is a US-led initiative for secure supply chains of AI-critical technologies; India joined in February 2026.
- India is the 4th largest troop contributor to UN Peacekeeping and was the first country to deploy an all-women contingent (2007).
- Major Abhilasha Barak received the UN Military Gender Advocate of the Year Award 2025 for work in UNIFIL, Lebanon.
- The International Day of UN Peacekeepers is observed on 29 May; the 2026 theme is Invest in Peace.

Mnemonic - FATF lists: Grey warns, Black blocks

Grey = Grey list: jurisdictions under increased monitoring, subject to regular progress reviews; Black = Black list: high-risk jurisdictions that FATF calls on members to apply countermeasures to

Mind-map outline

Governance, Global Bodies and Peacekeeping

- FCRA Amendment Rules 2026
 - Five NGO categories
 - Registration valid 5 years
- FATF lists
 - Grey list: increased monitoring
 - Black list: high-risk jurisdictions
- UN Peacekeeping
 - India 4th largest troop contributor
 - All-women contingent in 2007

Awards, Rankings, Health and Heritage

This group covers the Padma Awards 2026 and their rules, the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar and QS World University Rankings 2027. It also covers NFHS-6, International Day of Yoga 2026, the NCERT Dancing Girl restoration, and the proposed UNESCO nomination of Xuanzang's records.

- Padma Awards 2026 conferred 131 honours, including 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri.
- Padma Awards were instituted in 1954 and reorganised in 1955 into three categories.
- The maximum is 120 awards per year; the cap excludes posthumous awards, foreign nationals, NRIs and OCIs.
- Padma selection: recommendation by a committee chaired by the Cabinet Secretary, review by the PM, final approval by the President.

- PM Rashtriya Bal Puraskar honoured 19 children (ages 5-18); it was created in 2018 by merging two earlier awards.
- QS World University Rankings 2027: MIT retained the top position for the 15th consecutive year; IIT Delhi is India's highest-ranked institution at 118th.
- NFHS-6 (2023-24): institutional births rose from 88.6% to 90.6%; stunting declined from 35.5% to 29.3%.
- International Day of Yoga 2026 was the 12th edition, held on 21 June with the theme Yoga for Healthy Ageing.
- NCERT restored the original image of the Dancing Girl figurine, a bronze statuette of about 4,500 years, excavated from Mohenjo-daro.
- India and China are in advanced discussions to jointly nominate Xuanzang's 'Great Tang Records on the Western Regions' for UNESCO recognition.

Mnemonic - Padma award categories: Very Bright Stars

V = Padma Vibhushan: for exceptional and distinguished service of the highest order; B = Padma Bhushan: for distinguished service of a high order in any field; S = Padma Shri: for distinguished contributions in any discipline or area of public life

Mind-map outline

Awards, Rankings, Health and Heritage

- Padma Awards 2026
 - Vibhushan, Bhushan, Shri
 - Cap of 120 awards per year
- Rankings and surveys
 - QS 2027: MIT top for 15th year
 - NFHS-6: institutional births 90.6%
- Days and heritage
 - Yoga Day 21 June 2026
 - Dancing Girl image restored in NCERT